

Your grandparents' old condo

Was a tiny black-and-white thing with
A couple shingles missing and
Walls so thin you had to keep
Your laughter to a library whisper for
Fear the neighbors would
Threaten to break down the
Already chipped door;
Had a single cracked window out
Front you could peer through and
Find solace in the fact that
There would always be a light on in
The kitchen and a person sitting at the
Dining room table;
Was always fragrant with
Garden lemongrass or perhaps
Nivea lotion and on special occasions a
Cologne from Kohl's but
Always a scent you settled into like
The faded quilt spread across the
Peeling brown couch;
Had ten people over for
Dinner every week back when
Nobody worked on Sundays and
A second seemed like a lifetime but
You were far too young to
Realize you should have savored each
Second like you hold in your
Mouth each hearty spoonful of
Your grandmother's soup;
Has the same paper walls but
Painted different colors now to
Match the decor of the new
Tenants who would never be so
Lucky to know the way your
Cousin slid down the rickety
Banister nor the feeling of your
Aunt's hand on your shoulder as she
Told a story (good or bad) but
Most tragically of all the
Twinkles and crinkles adorning
Your grandfather's eyes.